

Response to RFP: Apex Systems

AI-Assisted Tier 2/3 Application Management & Service Desk Platform

Executive Summary

Apex Systems welcomes the opportunity to respond to Meridian's RFP for an AI-assisted Tier 2/3 application management and service desk platform. Apex has delivered comparable managed-services platforms for two other multinational energy-sector clients and proposes an architecture built around a modern, well-governed AI triage layer with explicit human-in-the-loop review for any automated action above a defined risk threshold.

Proposed Solution & Implementation Approach

Apex proposes a microservices-based platform with a dedicated triage engine that classifies incoming tickets using a fine-tuned classification model, routes them to the correct Tier 2/3 queue, and drafts (but does not auto-execute) suggested remediation steps for L2 engineers to approve. Integration with ServiceNow is delivered via a certified ServiceNow Technology Partner connector using REST APIs with OAuth 2.0, avoiding custom middleware. The architecture is designed to scale horizontally to handle a 3x seasonal ticket spike without manual intervention, validated through load testing at 4x baseline in our reference deployment for a comparable client. A documented rollback procedure reverts any AI-suggested classification to manual triage within 15 minutes if misclassification rates exceed 5% in a rolling one-hour window.

Timeline, Team Structure & Milestones

Apex proposes a 110-day transition: Days 1-20 discovery and environment access; Days 21-60 platform build and ServiceNow integration; Days 61-90 shadow-running alongside the incumbent; Days 91-110 phased cutover by application group. The delivery team includes a dedicated Transition Manager, a Solution Architect, 3 integration engineers, and a 24x7 support team of 18 engineers across three regional hubs. Note this exceeds the RFP's stated 90-day maximum by 20 days; Apex believes this additional time reduces cutover risk for a portfolio of this complexity, and is open to compressing the shadow-running phase if Meridian prefers to hold the 90-day target.

Price Table & Assumptions

Year 1 transition/setup cost: USD 480,000. Year 1 steady-state run cost: USD 95,000 per month. Year 2 steady-state run cost: USD 88,000 per month (volume efficiencies). Assumptions: baseline ticket volume of 9,000 tickets per month; up to 3x seasonal spikes included in the base

price; standard change requests (under 4 hours of effort) included; requests exceeding this threshold billed at USD 145/hour; pricing in USD, with a 3% annual indexation from Year 3 onward.

Security, Compliance & Risk Controls

Apex is ISO 27001:2022 certified (certificate renewed March 2025) and SOC 2 Type II audited annually. All production access requires MFA and is logged via a centralized SIEM with 400-day retention. All supplier personnel with production access undergo background checks prior to onboarding, and data processing is contractually restricted to the EU and India regions specified by Meridian. Apex maintains a documented incident response plan with a committed 4-hour initial response SLA for Severity 1 security incidents.

Support Model, Experience & References

Apex operates a follow-the-sun model across hubs in Krakow, Bengaluru, and Austin, with named regional leads and a defined L1-L2-L3 escalation matrix. Apex has delivered comparable application management platforms for two multinational energy and utilities clients over the past four years, including a 45-application portfolio for a European utilities group. References available on request, subject to the referee client's approval.